

25STCV10425 25STCV10425

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 309

Hearing date: 2026-07-16

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Case Number: 25STCV10425 Hearing Date: July 16, 2026 Dept: 309

Superior Court of California

County of Los Angeles

DEPARTMENT 309

TENTATIVE

RULING

MANUEL PANGA

vs.

COUNTY OF LOS ANGELES

Case No.: 25STCV10425

Hearing Date: July 16, 2026

The Court

adopts the County's proposed limiting language for Form Interrogatory No. 209.2.

On 4/7/2025,

Plaintiff Manuel Panga (Plaintiff) filed suit against County of Los Angeles, Los Angeles County Department of Health Services, and Los Angeles County Sheriff's Department, alleging: (1) disability discrimination; (2) failure to provide reasonable accommodation; (3) failure to engage in interactive process;

and (4) age discrimination.

On

6/25/2026, the Court requested supplemental briefing as to the appropriate scope of “me too” evidence related to Form Interrogatory No. 209.2.

Discussion

In its supplemental briefing,

Plaintiff proposed the following limiting language for Form Interrogatory No. 209.2:

Except

for this action, in the past 10 years has any employee filed a civil action against the EMPLOYER for disability discrimination, failure to engage in the interactive process, or failure to provide reasonable accommodation, in which the employee's leaves of absence, disability accommodation, interactive process, or return-to-work was handled by the Department of Health Services' Protected Leaves and Disability Management & Compliance unit (formerly the Return to Work unit)? If so, for each civil action:

(a)

state the name of each employee who filed the action;

(b)

state the court, names of the parties, and case number of the civil action;

(c)

state the name, address, and telephone number of any attorney representing the EMPLOYER; and

(d)

state whether the action has been resolved or is pending.

By contrast, Defendant

proposed:

Except

for this action, from January 1, 2015 to October 7, 2022, has any registered

nurse employed at the Correctional Treatment Center (CTC) filed a civil action against the EMPLOYER for disability discrimination, failure to engage in the interactive process, or failure to provide reasonable accommodation, in which the employee's disability accommodation, interactive process, or return-to-work was handled by the Department of Health Services' Protected Leaves and Disability Management & Compliance unit (formerly the Return to Work unit)? If so, for each civil action: (a) state the name of each employee who filed the action; (b) state the court, names of the parties, and case number of the civil action; (c) state the name, address, and telephone number of any attorney representing the EMPLOYER; and (d) state whether the action has been resolved or is pending.

As such, the two proposals are identical except that Plaintiff's version substitutes "any employee" for "registered nurse employed at the Correctional Treatment Center," extends the end date to "the present," and adds "leaves of absence" to the covered conduct.

After review, the Court finds Defendant's version to be appropriate. As noted by Defendant, this is a single-plaintiff action, not a class or pattern-and-practice case. The County's Department of Health Services is the second-largest municipal health system in the United States, operating multiple major medical centers and numerous outpatient clinics and serving hundreds of thousands of patients across millions of annual visits. A request reaching every disability-related civil action filed by any of the Department's tens of thousands of employees — across every classification, facility, and function, without regard to similarity to Plaintiff — is grossly disproportionate to the individual claims of a single registered nurse, and its burden clearly outweighs any likely benefit. (CCP § 2017.020.)

Moreover, the Court finds that to the extent leave of absence is at issue as a form of disability accommodation, it is already sufficiently captured by the request's existing categories — "failure to provide reasonable accommodation" and "failure to engage in the interactive process." The Court is unpersuaded by Plaintiff's argument to the contrary. Finally, the Court finds the County's proposed temporal scope — January 1, 2015 to October 7, 2022—to be factually appropriate.

Based on the foregoing, the Court adopts the County's proposed limiting language for Form Interrogatory No.

209.2.

It is so ordered.

Dated: July
, 2026

Hon. Jon R.
Takasugi

Judge of the
Superior Court

Parties who intend to submit on this tentative must send an email to the court at by 4 p.m. the day prior as directed by the instructions provided on the court website at www.lacourt.org. If a party submits on the tentative, the party's email must include the case number and must identify the party submitting on the tentative.

If all parties to a motion submit, the court will adopt this tentative as the final order. If the department does not receive an email indicating the parties are submitting on the tentative and there are no appearances at the hearing, the motion may be placed off calendar. For more information, please contact the court clerk at (213) 633-0517.